

FACTS
IDEAS
INSIGHTS
FOR A
BRIGHTER
TOMORROW

ClearExams

LEARN TODAY LEAD TOMORROW

Small
Updates
Big Picture

CURRENT AFFAIRS

DAILY DIGEST



15 SEPTEMBER 2026



POLITY &
GOVERNANCE



ECONOMY



INTERNATIONAL
RELATIONS



ENVIRONMENT



SCIENCE &
TECHNOLOGY



AGRICULTURE

STAY INFORMED
STAY AHEAD

A
MORE
INFORMED
A BRIGHTER
TOMORROW



KNOW TODAY. BUILD TOMORROW.

WORLD CIRCULAR ECONOMY FORUM 2026 OPENS IN GANDHINAGAR

PEOPLE | RESOURCES | A MORE RESILIENT TOMORROW



15 – 18
September 2026



Gandhinagar,
Gujarat, India

TOWARDS A
RESOURCE-EFFICIENT
AND SUSTAINABLE
WORLD

Global ideas.
Circular solutions.
A cleaner,
greener tomorrow.

WHAT IS A CIRCULAR ECONOMY?

An economic model that reduces waste and resource extraction by designing products and systems around reuse, repair, refurbishment, remanufacturing and recycling.

IN CONTRAST, THE
LINEAR MODEL FOLLOWS:

"Take – Make – Dispose"



KEY CONCEPTS



Extended Producer Responsibility (EPR)
Makes producers responsible for specified post-consumer waste management.



Resource Efficiency
Creating greater economic value with lower material and energy inputs.



SDG 12
Responsible Consumption and Production.

WHY IT MATTERS FOR INDIA

- Resource security
- Lower waste generation
- Reduced material import dependence
- Industrial competitiveness
- Green jobs
- Climate mitigation
- Sustainable consumption and production

A SHARED GLOBAL PLATFORM

- Brings together governments, industry, innovators and civil society
- Showcases circular economy approaches and India's initiatives on resource circularity
- Encourages knowledge exchange and collaboration for a sustainable future

CIRCULAR SOLUTIONS
STRONGER PEOPLE
CLEANER PLANET

RESOURCES CIRCULATE. OPPORTUNITIES GROW.

A CLEANER, GREENER, MORE
RESILIENT TOMORROW

GREAT INDIAN BUSTARD

NEW SOFT-RELEASE CENTRE OPENS

AT NALIYA, KACHCHH

GRASSLANDS
TODAY
BRIGHTER
TOMORROW

Conserving
Tomorrow's
Skies

A major step to strengthen conservation efforts for one of India's most threatened birds.



WHAT'S NEW?

A dedicated Great Indian Bustard soft-release centre has been inaugurated at Naliya in Kachchh, Gujarat (15 September 2026).

Three chicks rescued from Rajasthan will be reared here for about four to five months with minimal human intervention before their eventual release into the wild under established conservation protocols.

WHAT IS SOFT RELEASE?

A conservation method in which captive-bred or rehabilitated animals spend a transition period in controlled or semi-natural conditions before full release, helping them adapt to the wild and improving their survival prospects.



A SAFER START
FOR A WILDER TOMORROW

ABOUT GREAT INDIAN BUSTARD



Scientific name: *Ardeotis nigripennis*



IUCN status: Critically Endangered



Habitat: Grasslands and semi-arid regions



Major strongholds in India: Rajasthan and Kachchh, Gujarat



Major threats: Habitat loss and fragmentation, collision with overhead power lines

KEY HABITAT AREAS



CONSERVATION PROGRESS IN KACHCHH



~11 sq km
of *Prosopis juliflora*-
invaded grassland
restored



~30 km
predator-proof fencing
covering 15 sq km



'Jump-start' intervention

Infertile eggs laid by wild females are replaced with viable eggs from the conservation-breeding programme. A chick from a recent attempt survived beyond the critical first three months.

THE PATH FROM CAPTIVITY TO THE WILD



Conservation
breeding



Soft-release
centre (Naliya)



Acclimatisation
with minimal
human contact



Suitable
habitat



Monitored
release into the
wild

Healthy Grasslands
Support a Richer Tomorrow

PEOPLE
CONSERVATION
COEXISTENCE

INDIAN RUPEE UNDER PRESSURE

AS OIL SURGES; RBI MOVES TO ABSORB LIQUIDITY

Rising crude prices and global factors weaken the rupee, while the RBI steps in to manage volatility and absorb excess liquidity.

BRENT CRUDE
\$107.7
per barrel
(15 Sept 2026)

OIL

RUPEE HITS 1-MONTH LOW

₹95.92

per US dollar
(15 Sept 2026)

Weakest level in
more than a month



WHY OIL PRICES ARE RISING



Attacks on Saudi energy infrastructure disrupted supplies



Brent crude rose to about
\$107.7 per barrel
(15 Sept 2026)



Markets expect a US Federal Reserve rate hike, adding to global uncertainty

IMPACT ON INDIA



India is a major oil importer



Higher crude prices can increase the import bill



Raising inflation risks and putting pressure on the rupee

RBI'S RESPONSE



Using dollar sales through state-run banks to curb excessive currency volatility



Announced open-market bond sales totalling **₹1 trillion** in September 2026



₹500 billion sale scheduled for 15 September

These steps aim to absorb surplus rupee liquidity from the banking system.



FOREIGN-EXCHANGE RESERVES

~\$785 billion

India's forex reserves (at a record high), providing a buffer against external volatility.



10-YEAR GOVT BOND YIELD

~7.09%

Rising bond yields reflect tighter financial conditions and global spillovers.



KEY CONCEPTS



Currency depreciation means the rupee buys fewer US dollars.



Imported inflation occurs when a weaker currency and higher global commodity prices raise domestic costs.



Open Market Operations are RBI purchases or sales of government securities to inject or absorb liquidity. Selling government bonds absorbs rupee liquidity.



Forex intervention can moderate disorderly exchange rate movements but does not imply a fixed exchange rate.

HOW IT ALL CONNECTS



Global oil shock



Higher import bill / greater dollar demand



Rupee pressure + inflation risk



RBI intervention and liquidity absorption



Attempt to contain volatility and inflationary pressure

A STABLE RUPEE SUPPORTS
A STRONGER, MORE RESILIENT INDIA

INDIA'S INFLATION ACCELERATES

AUGUST 2026: CPI 4.8% | WPI 9.9%



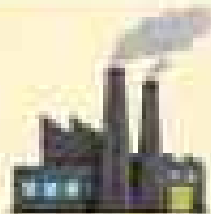
RETAIL INFLATION (CPI)



4.8%
in August 2026

- Highest since the new CPI series began in Jan 2026
- Food inflation rose to around 6%

WHOLESALE INFLATION (WPI)



9.9%
in August 2026

- Rose sharply, driven by higher commodity and input prices
- Reflects price changes at the wholesale level

WHAT DO CPI AND WPI MEAN?

CPI (Consumer Price Index)

- Measures changes in retail prices faced by consumers
- Main inflation gauge used for monetary-policy discussion
- Headline inflation includes all CPI components (food, fuel, etc.)
- Food inflation measures changes in food prices

WPI (Wholesale Price Index)

- Tracks price changes at the wholesale level
- Basket is dominated by goods (lesser weight to services)
- Can move differently from CPI due to different baskets, weights and coverage

● 1 basis point (bps) = 0.01 percentage point

HOW HIGHER PRICES TRANSMIT THROUGH THE ECONOMY



MONETARY POLICY CONTEXT



- Rising inflation has increased market expectations of possible monetary tightening.
- Monetary policy aims to maintain price stability while keeping growth in mind.

WHY CPI AND WPI CAN DIVERGE

- Different baskets and weights (e.g., services in CPI, goods heavy in WPI)
- Different stages of the supply chain (retail vs. wholesale)
- Different coverage and price collection methodologies
- Food and fuel shocks can impact WPI earlier and pass through to CPI over time.

HIGHER INFLATION HITS HOUSEHOLDS, BUSINESSES AND THE ECONOMY

INDIA PREPARES PM-KUSUM 2.0 WITH AGRIVOLTAICS PUSH

Same Land
More Possibilities



Union New and Renewable Energy Minister Pralhad Joshi said the government will launch a second edition of PM-KUSUM to enable farmers to generate renewable electricity alongside agricultural production.

Food and
Energy Together
for a Brighter Tomorrow

Power
to Farmers
Prosperity
to Farmers



WHAT IS AGRIVOLTAICS?

Co-locating solar photovoltaic panels and agriculture on the same land so that crops or other farm activities can continue while electricity is generated.



ABOUT PM-KUSUM

The original PM-KUSUM scheme promotes decentralised solar energy in agriculture, including solar power plants and solar agricultural pumps, with goals such as lower irrigation-energy costs and additional income opportunities for farmers.



PM-KUSUM 2.0 (ANNOUNCEMENT)

A second edition will be launched, with a dedicated **10 GW agri-photovoltaic component proposed**. Final operational details and scheme parameters are subject to government confirmation.

HOW AGRIVOLTAICS WORKS



Farmland + elevated or appropriately spaced solar panels



Crops continue to grow below or between panels



Electricity generation



Power for farm use or grid supply



Potential additional farmer income



KEY BENEFITS



Supplementary income for farmers



Renewable power generation



Lower fossil-fuel use and emissions



Productive dual land use



Decentralised renewable energy for rural areas



KEY CHALLENGES



High upfront costs



Suitable panel height and spacing



Crop-specific effects on yield



Grid connectivity and evacuation



Maintenance and land-use design

Risk of groundwater over-extraction if pumping becomes cheaper



GLOBAL FOCUS

Agrivoltaics World Conference 2026
is scheduled in New Delhi for 21-23 October 2026.



Sustainable Farms
Resilient Future

INDIA'S AUGUST 2026 TRADE DEFICIT NARROWS

STRONGER
TRADE
= STRONGER
INDIA

Lower gold imports help reduce the goods deficit;
services exports remain strong

15 September 2026

Trade
Connects
India
to the World



MERCHANDISE EXPORTS
(August 2026)

**US\$ 43.81
billion**



MERCHANDISE IMPORTS
(August 2026)

**US\$ 70.67
billion**



**MERCHANDISE
TRADE DEFICIT**
(August 2026)

**US\$ 26.86
billion**

(vs US\$ 32 billion
in July 2026)



GOLD IMPORTS

US\$ 2.3 billion

(vs US\$ 4.36 billion
in July 2026)



SERVICES EXPORTS
(August 2026)

**US\$ 38.87
billion**



SERVICES TRADE SURPLUS
(August 2026)

**US\$ 17.45
billion**



**COMBINED GOODS &
SERVICES EXPORTS**
(August 2026)

**US\$ 82.68
billion**



~25%
(year-on-year)



TOP EXPORT DESTINATION
(April–August 2026)



United States
remained India's
leading export
destination

WHAT IS A TRADE DEFICIT?

Occurs when merchandise imports
exceed merchandise exports.



THE BIGGER PICTURE

The Current Account includes
trade in goods and services,
plus primary and secondary income.

- A strong services surplus
can partly offset the
merchandise trade deficit
in the overall external account.



WHY GOLD IMPORTS MATTER?

Lower gold imports reduce
pressure on the merchandise
import bill.



IMPACT OF HIGH CRUDE-OIL PRICES

Higher crude-oil prices can
increase India's import bill,
as India is a major oil importer.



WHY THIS MATTERS?

- External-sector stability
- Rupee demand and supply
- Foreign-exchange needs
- Import dependence
- Export competitiveness
- Current-account dynamics

A Stronger External Sector
Builds a Brighter India



COMPETITIVE
INDIA
CONNECTED
INDIA
PROSPEROUS
INDIA

INDIA – MERCOSUR

15 SEPT
2026

PTA EXPANSION TALKS LAUNCHED

India and MERCOSUR have formally launched negotiations to expand their existing Preferential Trade Agreement.



WHAT IS A PREFERENTIAL TRADE AGREEMENT (PTA)?



- Participating countries reduce tariffs on a selected list of products.
- Unlike a full free trade agreement, tariffs are not necessarily eliminated across substantially all trade.

INDIA – MERCOSUR PTA



- In place since 2009.
- Now, negotiations have been launched to expand the agreement with wider product coverage and deeper tariff preferences.

WHY EXPANSION MATTERS FOR INDIA



Wider preferential market access in South America



Export diversification and deeper engagement with Latin America



Opportunities for pharmaceuticals, engineering goods, automobiles/auto components, chemicals, textiles and agricultural trade



Domestic sectors may also face greater import competition

IMPORTANT CONCEPTS



Preferential tariff
Lower tariff rate on agreed products for partner countries.



Rules of origin
Criteria used to determine where a product originates and whether it qualifies for preferential tariff treatment.



Trade diversification
Expanding exports to new markets and across a wider range of products.



Regional trade agreement
Trade agreement among a group of countries in a region to promote trade and economic cooperation.

PATH AHEAD



India + MERCOSUR negotiate wider product coverage and tariff preferences



Lower barriers on agreed goods



More trade and supply-chain links



Stronger economic ties between India and South America

FROM THE INDIAN OCEAN
TO A STRONGER TOMORROW

UK-INDIA TELECOM COOPERATION TO USE AI AGAINST DIGITAL FRAUD

Stronger networks. Safer users. A more secure digital future.



**MoU signed on
14 September 2026**

Announced by the
British High Commission
in New Delhi on
15 September 2026



Who signed?

UK government and the
Cellular Operators
Association of India (COAI)

A Memorandum of Understanding
to cooperate on artificial-
intelligence-enabled telecom
approaches to tackle online fraud,
scams and digital harms.



HOW AI HELPS IN TELECOM FRAUD DETECTION

- Analyses network patterns and unusual activity
- Identifies suspicious calls, messages and behaviour
- Helps detect and flag potential scam networks in real time
- Supports faster response by telecom operators and authorities



TELECOM CYBERSECURITY

- Protects communications networks, services and users from digital threats
- Involves threat monitoring, fraud detection, network security and user protection
- Critical for safe digital payments, online services and an inclusive digital economy



WHY CROSS-BORDER COOPERATION MATTERS

- Fraud networks, telecom routes and digital platforms often operate across countries
- Enables information and technical cooperation
- Helps deal with evolving and transnational cyber threats
- Builds shared expertise for a safer global digital ecosystem

HOW THE COOPERATION WORKS



OPPORTUNITIES

- Faster detection of suspicious activity
- Knowledge and best-practice sharing
- Improved fraud intelligence
- Safer digital payments and communications
- Supports a trusted and inclusive digital economy



KEY CHALLENGES

- Privacy and data protection
- False positives and error risks
- Algorithmic accountability and transparency
- Cybersecurity and data misuse risks
- Jurisdictional issues in cross-border cases
- Need for responsible and ethical use of AI



WHAT AN MoU MEANS

- A Memorandum of Understanding records a framework for cooperation and intent.
- It is generally not the same as a treaty and does not, by itself, create binding international legal obligations.
- Specific projects and actions will be taken forward through further discussions and agreements.

CURRENT AFFAIRS

— DAILY DIGEST —



16 SEPTEMBER 2026

KEY DEVELOPMENTS
BIGGER PICTURE
BRIGHTER PREPARATION

*Facts
Today
A Stronger
Tomorrow*



POLITY &
GOVERNANCE

ECONOMY

ENVIRONMENT

SCIENCE &
TECHNOLOGY

AGRICULTURE

INTERNATIONAL
RELATIONS

A MORE INFORMED YOU
A BRIGHTER TOMORROW

INDIA CABINET RAISES EPF WAGE CEILING TO ₹25,000

Decision to extend provident fund coverage to more salaried workers



WHAT CHANGED?

Earlier
₹15,000
per month



New
₹25,000
per month

The Union Cabinet has approved raising the wage ceiling for EPF coverage from ₹15,000 to ₹25,000.

WHAT IS EPF?

Employees' Provident Fund (EPF) is a statutory retirement savings and social security mechanism for eligible employees, administered by the Employees' Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO).



SAVE TODAY

SECURE
TOMORROW

SOCIAL SECURITY
FOR A STRONGER
INDIA

WHY IT MATTERS



Wider coverage

More salaried workers to be brought under EPF, especially those earning between ₹15,000 and ₹25,000.



Stronger retirement savings

Helps build long-term financial security for a larger section of workers.



Compliance impact

May lead to higher contributions and payroll adjustments for employers and employees.

LEGAL AND POLICY CONTEXT



Employees' Provident Funds and Miscellaneous Provisions Act, 1952

Governs the EPF framework in India.



Directive Principles of State Policy (Article 41)

Supports the State's responsibility to provide for social security and public assistance.

INDIA LAUNCHES NET ZERO PORTAL & NAPCC DASHBOARD

New digital platforms to strengthen India's climate action, monitoring and transparency

*Cleaner Air
Safer Climate
Greener Tomorrow*



*From
Commitment
to Action*



16 September 2026

Union Minister of State for Environment, Forest and Climate Change

Kirti Vardhan Singh launched India's Net Zero Portal and NAPCC Dashboard in Mumbai on World Ozone Day.



Objective

To strengthen climate reporting, government monitoring, coordination, transparency and evidence-based decision-making across India's climate action.

NET ZERO PORTAL

Tracking India's Long-Term Net-Zero Transition



Tracks and reports progress towards India's **net-zero transition**



Brings together key data, reports and resources



Helps assess progress and supports evidence-based policy decisions

NAPCC DASHBOARD

Monitoring India's Climate Missions



Monitors and tracks implementation of the **National Action Plan on Climate Change (NAPCC)**



Improves coordination across different missions and stakeholders



Enhances **transparency** and **real-time monitoring** of outcomes



What is NAPCC?

The **National Action Plan on Climate Change (NAPCC)** is India's umbrella framework for climate action, comprising multiple national missions on key areas such as solar energy, energy efficiency, sustainable habitat, water, agriculture, forests and more.



**INDIA'S
NET-ZERO TARGET
2070**



**WORLD OZONE DAY
16 SEPTEMBER**

Focuses on protecting the ozone layer for a healthier planet and a safer climate.



**CLIMATE ACTION
TODAY
A HEALTHIER
TOMORROW**

INDIA – UAE MARITIME INDUSTRY

BUILDING
A MORE
CONNECTED
MARITIME
FUTURE

COCHIN SHIPYARD – DRYDOCKS WORLD

50 : 50 JOINT VENTURE

Stronger Ships. Stronger Seas. A Stronger Partnership.

INDIA
UAE
PEOPLE
PARTNERSHIP
PROGRESS



WHAT HAPPENED?

Cochin Shipyard Limited (CSL) and Drydocks World (a DP World company, Dubai) signed a joint venture agreement on **16 September 2026** to operate, consolidate and expand the International Ship Repair Facility at Kochi, Kerala.



50 : 50 JV

- Each partner will hold **50%**.
- Builds on an MoU signed during India Maritime Week 2025.
- Described as a **first-of-its-kind public-private partnership** in India's ship-repair sector.



WHY KOCHI MATTERS

- Strategic location near major international shipping routes in the Arabian Sea.
- Modern docking and ship-lift infrastructure.
- Enables faster turnaround for Indian, regional and international vessels.



POLICY CONNECTION

- Supports the **Maritime Amrit Kaal Vision 2047**.
- Aligns with India's goal of becoming a **globally competitive shipbuilding and ship-repair hub**.
- Strengthens **India-UAE economic cooperation** in the maritime sector.



NSE LAUNCHES ₹2.3 BILLION IPO

India's stock market giant goes public

16 SEPTEMBER 2026



WHAT HAPPENED?



India's National Stock Exchange (NSE) launched its long-awaited initial public offering (IPO) on 16 September 2026, targeting about **US\$2.3 billion**, making it one of India's largest IPOs.

IPO SNAPSHOT



Issue size
~ US\$2.3 billion
(around ₹19,500 crore)



Price band
₹1,700 – ₹1,785
per share



Implied valuation
~ US\$46 billion
(at upper end of the band)

OFFER FOR SALE — WHAT IT MEANS



This IPO is an offer for sale (OFS) by existing shareholders, so NSE itself does not receive fresh capital. Proceeds generally go to the selling shareholders, not the company.

IPO = first public sale/listing of a company's shares.

OFS = existing shareholders sell shares and the proceeds go to those shareholders.

WHY IT MATTERS FOR INDIA'S CAPITAL MARKETS



Deepens India's equity markets and broadens retail participation.



Marks a key milestone for the country's financial infrastructure.



May improve transparency and governance through public listing norms.



Reinforces India's position as a global financial hub.

ABOUT NSE



World's largest derivatives exchange by trading volume.



Options trading is a major revenue source.



Derivatives volumes have fallen from their 2024 peak after tighter regulation and trading-rule changes.

EXAM CONCEPTS



Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) – India's securities-market regulator.



IPO, OFS, stock exchange, capital markets, market regulation, financial infrastructure.



NSE's role in equity and derivatives markets and its significance for India's economy.

INDIA IMPLEMENTS INDIA-UK CETA



16
SEPTEMBER
2026

AUTO TARIFF-RATE QUOTA

642 UK cars approved for import
under the pact

*Stronger
Partnership
Broader
Opportunities*



WHAT HAPPENED?



642 UK cars
approved for import
for the remainder of 2026
under CETA's tariff-rate-quota
provisions.



7 companies
granted approval by the
Directorate General of
Foreign Trade (DGFT).



DGFT had invited
applications in July 2026
for the quota covering fully
built passenger cars and
goods vehicles.

WHY IT MATTERS



Marks the practical
implementation of FTA
market access commitments.



Calibrated tariff liberalisation
can boost trade, investment
and consumer choice.



Quota limits help manage
competitive impact on
domestic industry while
enabling gradual opening.

WHAT IS A TARIFF RATE QUOTA (TRQ)?



A Tariff Rate Quota allows
a specified quantity of imports
to enter at a lower or
preferential customs duty.
Imports outside the quota
face the normal applicable
tariff.

INDIA-UK CETA



- Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement (CETA) between India and the UK.
- Entered into force on 15 July 2026.
- Includes tariff concessions for sectors such as automobiles, with quota-based and phased liberalisation.

KEY EXAM CONCEPTS



- Free Trade Agreement (FTA)
- Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement (CETA)
- Tariff and customs duty
- Quota and Tariff Rate Quota (TRQ)
- Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT)
- India's trade policy and market access negotiations



Open Markets Stronger Economies Shared Prosperity

INDIA CONSIDERS CUTTING EDIBLE-OIL IMPORT DUTY

16 SEPTEMBER 2026

UNDER CONSIDERATION
NOT YET A FINAL NOTIFIED DUTY CUT

India is considering a modest reduction of about **5 percentage points** in the basic import duty on vegetable oils.



WHY NOW?



- Domestic edible-oil prices have risen nearly **20%** over the past year.
- High food-inflation pressure, especially ahead of the festival-demand period.

INDIA'S IMPORT DEPENDENCE

India imports about **TWO-THIRDS** of its vegetable-oil requirements.

Major imports: palm oil, soybean oil and sunflower oil.



POLICY TRADE-OFF



Lower import duty could reduce consumer food costs and help contain **food inflation**.



Need to avoid **hurting domestic oilseed farmers**, especially soybean growers.

GLOBAL LINK

Lower Indian tariffs could increase import demand, potentially influencing international vegetable-oil prices, as India is the world's largest importer of vegetable oils.



BACKGROUND

India had already halved the basic import tax on crude edible oils in May 2025 to help ease prices.



EXAM CONCEPTS

- Import duty and tariff policy
- Food inflation and price stability
- Edible-oil import dependence of India
- Major edible oils: palm, soybean, sunflower
- Agricultural trade policy and farmer interests
- Impact of trade policy on global commodity prices

16 SEPTEMBER 2026

CABINET APPROVES DISSOLUTION OF DIGITAL COMMUNICATIONS COMMISSION

End of a 37-year-old apex body
for telecom policy coordination



WHAT CHANGED?

- Union Cabinet approved winding up the Digital Communications Commission (DCC).
- DCC to be dissolved after about 37 years.



INSTITUTIONAL HISTORY



WHAT DCC DID

- Apex inter-ministerial body for telecom policy and administrative decision-making under the Department of Telecommunications (DoT).
- Handled key issues such as spectrum, licensing, and overall telecom policy coordination across ministries.



AFTER DISSOLUTION

- Final telecom policy and administrative decisions will now be handled directly by the Telecom Secretary.
- Subject to approval by the Communications Minister and Cabinet where required.



EXAM CONCEPTS

- **Department of Telecommunications (DoT):** Union government department for telecom policy, licensing, spectrum management and overall sector development.
- **Telecom governance:** Policy-making (government) vs. regulation (TRAI) — distinct roles.
- **TRAI:** Independent statutory regulator under the TRAI Act, 1997. Not being dissolved.
- **Administrative reform:** Streamlining decision-making and reducing overlapping bodies.
- **Satellite broadband:** Growing importance in India's digital connectivity landscape.



EXPANDING
HORIZONS
THROUGH
DIGITAL
CONNECTIVITY

INDIA–PAKISTAN NAVAL COLLISION

IN NORTH ARABIAN SEA

16 SEPTEMBER 2026

SAFER
SEAS
STRONGER
STABILITY

— DIALOGUE
RULES
REDUCE
RISKS



WHAT HAPPENED?



On **15 September 2026**, an Indian Navy warship and a Pakistani naval vessel collided in international waters in the **northern Arabian Sea**.



No major damage or casualties were reported.

1991 AGREEMENT

ON ADVANCE NOTICE OF MILITARY ACTIVITIES



Under the **1991 India–Pakistan Agreement on Advance Notice of Military Exercises, Manoeuvres and Troops Movements**, naval ships and submarines of the two countries are to maintain a distance of at least **three nautical miles** from each other in international waters to avoid accidents.

DIPLOMATIC RESPONSE



- India summoned Pakistan's Charge d'Affaires on 16 September 2026.
- India said the Pakistani vessel's conduct was unacceptable and unprofessional.
- India also instructed its Charge d'Affaires in Islamabad to lodge a parallel protest.

INDIA'S POSITION



- The Pakistani vessel's conduct was unacceptable and unprofessional.
- Cited the 1991 agreement on maintaining a 3 nautical mile distance.

PAKISTAN'S POSITION



- Disputed India's account.
- Blamed the Indian vessel for the incident.

WHY IT MATTERS



- Supports confidence-building measures (CBMs) between the two nations.
- Important for maritime security and safe navigation.
- Helps prevent potential escalation and crises at sea.
- Impacts overall bilateral relations and regional stability.

EXAM CONCEPTS



- Arabian Sea** – a key maritime region in the Indian Ocean.
- International waters** – areas beyond national jurisdiction.
- Charge d'Affaires** – head of mission when an ambassador is not posted.
- Confidence-building measures (CBMs)** – steps to reduce risk of conflict.
- Bilateral military agreements** – frameworks to ensure transparency and avoid incidents.

CLEAREXAMS

CURRENT AFFAIRS

DAILY DIGEST

19 SEPTEMBER 2026

TODAY'S 6 EXAM-RELEVANT UPDATES

- Environment & NGT
- Government recruitment
- India-Canada trade
- Southwest monsoon
- India growth outlook
- H-1B visa policy

Phone-first • concise • source-grounded

your path to success

NGT climate conference opens in New Delhi

Two-day international conference: 19-20 September 2026

17 COUNTRIES

Judicial representatives from 17 countries are participating.

- The National Green Tribunal (NGT) is organising the conference on 'The Future of Environment and Climate Dynamics'.
- The Prime Minister inaugurated the conference and released an NGT Mobile Application.
- Core themes include environmental governance, policy gaps, implementation, enforcement and institutional cooperation.
- Exam link: NGT is a specialised environmental adjudicatory body; environmental governance often connects law, science and federal administration.

20th Rozgar Mela

Nationwide government recruitment event

51,000+

Appointment letters distributed in the 20th edition.

- The 20th Rozgar Mela was held across 45 locations in the country.
- Recruits are joining departments including Revenue, Railways, Home Affairs, Health & Family Welfare, Financial Services and Defence.
- Across 20 editions, about 12.75 lakh appointment letters have been distributed.
- Exam link: distinguish a recruitment initiative from a statutory employment-guarantee programme; recruitment continues through established agencies and sanctioned posts.

India-Canada CEPA talks gain momentum

Canada says it is optimistic about concluding talks by end-2026

CEPA

Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement — broader than a basic tariff-cutting FTA.

- Canada's trade minister said Indian negotiators are expected to visit Canada next month.
- Key areas under discussion include LNG and energy, nuclear cooperation, critical minerals and resilient supply chains.
- Indian companies are exploring investment opportunities in Canadian critical-mineral projects.
- Status check: negotiations are ongoing; the year-end timeline is an objective, not a concluded agreement.

Southwest Monsoon withdrawal begins

IMD: withdrawal from some parts of West Rajasthan on 19 September

19 SEP

Official start of 2026 monsoon withdrawal from parts of West Rajasthan.

- Withdrawal typically starts from northwestern India and progresses toward the southeast.
- The withdrawal phase is associated with weakening monsoon circulation over northwest India and changing pressure/wind patterns.
- Exam link: 'retreating monsoon' is especially important for Tamil Nadu because the northeast monsoon later becomes its major rainy season.
- Track IMD's withdrawal line and subsequent Bay of Bengal systems separately — they can still produce heavy rain after withdrawal starts in the northwest.

Moody's lifts India's FY27 growth forecast

Real GDP growth forecast revised upward

7.0%

Moody's FY2027 real GDP growth forecast, up from 6.0%.

- India's April-June quarter growth was reported at 7.8% year-on-year.
- Moody's cited resilience despite Middle East conflict-related pressures.
- Key risks flagged: elevated global energy prices and El Niño-related food inflation.
- Exam link: higher oil prices can affect inflation, the current account, subsidies and fiscal consolidation.

U.S. extends H-1B fee policy

One-year extension; legal challenges remain ongoing

\$100,000

Fee specified for new H-1B non-immigrant visa applications under the extended order.

- The extension applies to new H-1B applications under the order; current visa holders and certain foreign graduates already in the U.S. are exempt.
- The measure is being challenged in U.S. courts, so implementation remains legally contested.
- India angle: H-1B policy is significant for Indian skilled workers and technology-sector hiring.
- Exam link: H-1B is a U.S. non-immigrant employment visa category for specialty occupations.

A
BRIGHTER
INFORMED
TOMORROW



*Knowledge
Builds
Brighter
Lives*

CURRENT AFFAIRS DAILY DIGEST

CURIOSITY
DISCIPLINE
PROGRESS
A BRIGHTER YOU

20 SEPTEMBER 2026

PEOPLE
IDEAS
SOLUTIONS
A BETTER
TOMORROW



ClearExams.ink

SLINEX-26

India and Sri Lanka at sea



13th edition



17–21 September 2026



Visakhapatnam



PARTICIPATING SHIPS

India:

INS Kavaratti • INS Jyoti

Sri Lanka:

SLNS Sindurala



TWO PHASES



Harbour:

professional exchanges
and crew visits.



Sea:

coordinated naval
activities.



PURPOSE

Improve the two navies' ability to operate together
and strengthen maritime cooperation.



REMEMBER

SLINEX was first conceptualised in 2005.

INDIA WATER WEEK

9th India International
Water Week



UPCOMING EVENT

22–26 September 2026

Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi



THEME

Climate Resilient Water Management



WHO IS ORGANISING IT?

Ministry of Jal Shakti



INTERNATIONAL PARTNERS

The Netherlands and Germany



WHAT TO WATCH

Water governance, climate risks, technology, community participation and financing.



EVENT CALENDAR

22–25 Sep: technology exhibition

22–24 Sep: international WASH conference

26 Sep: study tours

COAL INDIA

A broader energy and minerals portfolio



FIVE AREAS OF EXPANSION

- 1 Coal gasification and chemicals
- 2 Thermal electricity generation
- 3 Renewables and energy storage
- 4 Critical minerals and advanced materials
- 5 Other minerals, including iron ore

PORTFOLIO SNAPSHOT



About ₹69,346 crore

Estimated cost across four coal-to-chemicals projects



About 550 MW

Solar capacity already commissioned

TECHNOLOGY TERM



BESS = Battery Energy Storage System

STATUS MATTERS



The portfolio includes both operating assets and projects under development.

FINANCING VIKSIT BHARAT



NEWS UPDATE

A two-day conference on development finance concluded in New Delhi on 19 September.



WHO TOOK PART?

Union and State representatives, finance officials, researchers, bankers and industry experts.



THREE PRIORITIES

- Attract more private investment.
- Prepare stronger, finance-ready projects.
- Strengthen States' capital spending.



SECTORS IN FOCUS



Agriculture



Energy transition



Banking



Technology



WHAT COMES NEXT?

Working groups with State participation will develop sector-specific financing recommendations.

DISHA 2.0

Making justice more accessible



WHY IN THE NEWS?

A regional workshop is scheduled in Goa on 21 September 2026.



DISHA MEANS

Designing Innovative Solutions for Holistic Access to Justice



SCHEME BASICS



Central Sector Scheme



Department of Justice



1 April 2026 – 31 March 2031



₹255 crore

Approved funding for 2026–31



3 crore people

Targeted cumulative outreach



DIGITAL ADDITION

VIDHI-Sanjeevani introduces a central digital platform and the Nyaya Setu AI chatbot.

